



DUKE FUQUA

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT THE SCHOOL

In its relatively short history, The Fuqua School of Business at Duke University has established itself as one of the leading MBA programs in the world. Based in Durham, North Carolina, Duke is part of the world-renowned Research Triangle Park (RTP), one of the oldest and largest science parks in the US with over 200 companies ranging from startups to multinational organizations. In fact, the Triangle area has recently received national recognition as one of the best places for business and careers.

Fuqua and Duke see themselves as a vital part of this growth. They are looking for individuals who want to do well in business, but also want to make a positive impact their community and the world. (Prominent alumni include Apple CEO Tim Cook and philanthropist Melinda Gates.) The Fuqua culture is incredibly collaborative and close-knit - Team Fuqua isn't just a saying, but a commitment that the students, faculty and staff make to one another (which extends to partners of students). Fuqua may have a reputation for marketing & general management, but consulting has quickly become a major area of focus; six of its top 10 employers were consulting firms last year.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

*Health Sector Management, Marketing, Technology, Social
Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurship & Innovation*

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek	12	-	15	14	-	7	19	2
Financial Times	11	10	12	12	-	10	10	10
Forbes	-	6	-	5	-	5	-	6
The Economist	2	2	2	3	-	8	11	10
US News	9	9	9	9	-	8	10	12

CLASS OF 2021 ADMISSIONS

Number of Applicants	2,032	Avg Age	28
MBA Class Size	284	Avg GMAT	723
Admissions selectivity	34.5%	Avg GPA	3.52
Yield	40.51%	% International	38%
Total Tuition	\$155,040	% Women	42%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASSES OF 2019)

Financial Services	25%
Consulting	20%
Technology	13%
Government, Military, Nonprofit	13%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

McKinsey & Company, Bain & Company, Amazon, Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation, BCG, L.E.K Consulting, JP Morgan, WAYFAIR, Microsoft, Eli Lilly, Google

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: US\$139,046

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 98%

*Rankings are relative to other U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR DUKE FUQUA APPLICATION

BY CATHERINE FINCH TUTTLE

Catherine brings deep MBA experience as a former Associate Director at Duke University's Fuqua School of Business. For five years she worked in the Career Management Center creating, implementing, and evaluating programs and coaching MBA's to achieve their career goals. She also served as the liaison to Admissions having worked with them earlier in her career as a Marketing Manager.



[Your application] should resonate with the core values of the Fuqua community - collaboration, diversity, honesty, respect and giving back to a cause greater than yourself.

1

KNOW WHAT TEAM FUQUA MEANS TO YOU

On the surface, Team Fuqua can seem like a tagline or gimmicky slogan, but that's far from the truth. Typically, applicants who devote the necessary time to networking with students and alumni will start to understand what this means on a deeper level. They will hear stories about how students who are competing for the same internship help each other prepare for their interviews, how willing current students are to connect across programs, how alumni continue to engage with the school long after graduation, and how faculty and staff host international students over holiday breaks when they are unable to return to their home country. The sum of the Fuqua community is truly greater than the individual parts and the stories are endless. You need to share your experience and understanding of this deeply relational value throughout your application. 'Tell me what Team Fuqua means to you' is also a favored question among interviewers – both current students and alumni!

BE CLEAR ABOUT YOUR CAREER GOALS & WHY FUQUA

2

At Fuqua, Admissions and the Career Management Center (CMC) are well connected. Career Center staff educate the team on what to look for in resumes and the key skills/experience required for certain career paths. If questions arise about a candidate, their experience, and how realistic their goals are, they will bring in the Associate Dean of the CMC to get her feedback. That said, you need to be quite clear about your development so far, the specific experience/skills needed from the Duke MBA, and how it all translates short- and long-term.

3

ENVISION YOURSELF ON CAMPUS

The second essay asks you how you see yourself contributing to the community outside the classroom. Outside the classroom is key. All too often applicants ignore that part of the prompt and wax poetic about how their experience will add value in class discussions. You must go deeper. Fuqua boasts 60+ student clubs, each of which was started and run by students. These clubs and other experiential opportunities allow you to take initiative and flex the leadership muscle they are building in the program. Think about the groups you will be a part of – professional clubs and those that are more light hearted like the Outdoors Club and Wine Club. Then, reflect on your past experience and how it will contribute to Fuqua’s mission/goals. If you talk to club members, you’ll be even better equipped to articulate how you can add value in vivid detail.

ESSAY ANALYSIS

The short answer and essay questions are an opportunity for you to tell your story in a way that speaks to Fuqua's core values of collaboration, diversity, integrity, respect, and community engagement.



REQUIRED ESSAY 1. 25 Random Things About Yourself

The full prompt clearly states that Admissions wants to get to know you beyond the professional and academic achievements listed on your resume. This is your opportunity to connect on a personal level by showcasing a different side (or sides) of yourself that may not come through in traditional MBA applications. If done right, this essay is where you create advocates among those reading your list.

Think about your values, your hobbies, your interests and important life experiences. These can and should be a mix of poignant, humorous, playful, deep, and everything in between. Some may be a paragraph whereas others may be a simple sentence. Also keep in mind that they should resonate with the core values of the Fuqua community mentioned above.

It's also important to highlight your cultural competency. Fuqua has always put an emphasis on diversity and takes pride in the fact that its student body is consistently around 40% international. Look for ways to stress your experience working with globally diverse teams and why a global perspective is important to you personally and professionally.

REQUIRED ESSAY 2. The Fuqua community and you – what are 3 ways you expect to contribute at Fuqua? (300 words)

This essay asks you to dig deep into the engagement opportunities on campus and pick 3 that clearly align with your story, both past and present. Dedicating a significant amount of time to networking with

students and alumni is essential so that you can envision yourself on campus and articulate how you will add value to the community. As an added bonus, students and alumni are encouraged to submit online recommendations after engaging with prospective students and their opinions are highly valued by Admissions.

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Reflect on your past experience and how it will contribute to mission and goals of whatever opportunities you choose. If you have networked effectively, you'll be equipped to articulate how you can add value in vivid detail.

SHORT ANSWER ESSAY 3. Fuqua Required
Short Answer: What are your post-MBA
career goals? Share with us your first choice
career plan and your alternate plan. (500
characters with spaces)

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realistic their goals are, they will bring in the Associate Dean of the CMC to get her feedback. That said, you need to be quite clear about your development so far, the skills needed from the Duke MBA, and how it all translates post-MBA.

While I wouldn't recommend spending too much character count on your plan B, it is an incredibly important part of your answer. The MBA is a dynamic and transformative experience. At orientation, staff would often joke with the new class that more than half of them would end up doing something completely different than what they wrote about in their application. The point of plan B is to show that you have thought clearly about more than one option and how they will get you to your goals short- and long-term. That way, when the wind changes (and it will), you will be prepared to adjust your sails!

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	INTERVIEW INVITATIONS	FINAL DECISIONS
Early Action	23 September 2020	8 October 2020	27 November 2020
Round 1	20 October 2020	10 November 2020	18 December 2020
Round 2	07 January 2021	2 February 2021	19 March 2021
Round 3	25 March 2021	08 April 2021	30 April 2021

***COVID-19**

For the latest updates about how COVID-19 is impacting admissions and programming at MIT and all top MBA programs, please visit our [blog](#).



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

